

LISTENING

#22

1 – Listen to a news report about changing attitudes toward avocados. Pay attention to why chefs are abandoning the fruit, what environmental issues are mentioned, and what alternatives are being used in restaurants.

The Dark Side of Avocados

1 - How does the presenter describe the avocado at the beginning?

- a) As a controversial discovery
- b) As a food world celebrity
- c) As a disappointing trend

2 - According to the report, where is the majority of avocado farming happening?

3 - How does the reporter describe the attitude of cafes in East London toward avocados?

- a) They are ignoring them
- b) They have fully embraced them
- c) They have banned them

4 - What major concern is making chefs move away from avocados?

- a) Their taste is declining
- b) They are becoming too cheap
- c) Their environmental impact

5 - What alternative ingredients are some restaurants using instead of avocado in guacamole?

- a) Mango and coconut
- b) Peas and courgettes
- c) Potatoes and rice

6 - What does the environmental expert say is a problem with avocado crops?

- a) They attract insects
- b) They require large amounts of water
- c) They are dangerous to harvest

7 - What reason, besides the environment, does the chef give for removing avocados?

- a) Labor shortages
- b) Cost increases
- c) Connections to organized crime

8 - What violent consequence is mentioned regarding avocado producers?

- a) Producers are forced to attend protests
- b) Families have had to flee and people have been killed
- c) Workers must pay higher taxes

Full Name _____

READING COMPREHENSION

Is The World Ready for Sustainable Avocados?

In recent years, the avocado has grown from a niche fruit to a global symbol of healthy eating. Its image has been boosted by social media, modern cafés, and celebrity endorsements, turning it into a fashionable ingredient for toast, salads, smoothies, and many other dishes. As demand has increased dramatically in Europe and North America, production has also risen, especially in Mexico, the world's largest exporter.

However, environmental groups are warning that this booming trade carries hidden costs. Avocados require a huge amount of water to grow, far more than most people realise. This is particularly worrying in regions already suffering from droughts or long dry seasons. As plantations expand, forests and natural habitats are being cleared to create space for new avocado farms. Environmentalists say this is reducing biodiversity, affecting wildlife, and placing greater pressure on local water supplies.

There are also concerns about the human impact. In some areas, criminal groups have tried to gain control over the industry, taking advantage of its profitability. Reports suggest that growers have been threatened, land has been seized, and entire families have been forced to leave their homes. While many farmers depend on avocado exports for their income, the rapid growth of the trade has created tensions and risks for communities.

In response, researchers and producers are searching for more sustainable solutions—such as improving irrigation systems, planting more resilient trees, and monitoring farming practices more carefully. Some restaurants are offering alternative versions of guacamole that use peas or other vegetables instead of avocados, hoping to reduce pressure on the industry.

Despite the challenges, global demand continues to rise. Experts say the future of the avocado will depend on whether farming can become more sustainable—and whether consumers are willing to ask where their food comes from

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Comprehension Questions

1. Why has the avocado become a fashionable ingredient in recent years?

2. What environmental problems are linked to increased avocado production?

3. What risks are some communities facing because of the avocado trade?

4. Would you support restaurants that offer alternatives to avocado? Why or why not?
